

CJ Libassi

Senior Research Associate, PEER Center, American University

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RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

PEER Center, American University

Senior Research Associate

May 2026–Present

US Department of Education, Office of the Chief Economist

Washington

Senior Advisor and Federation of American Scientists Impact Fellow

May 2022–January 2024

Community College Research Center

New York

Senior Research Assistant

June 2021–May 2026

College Board

Washington

Senior Policy Research Analyst

April 2018–March 2021

George Washington University

Washington

Professorial Lecturer

January 2018–May 2021

Center for American Progress

Washington

Policy Analyst

July 2016–April 2018

Education Policy Initiative, University of Michigan

Ann Arbor

Research Area Specialist

May 2015–June 2016

Comunidad de Madrid

Madrid

Fulbright English Teaching Assistant

September 2012–June 2013

Prince George's County Public Schools

Upper Marlboro

Foreign Language Teacher / Teach For America Corps Member

June 2010–June 2012

EDUCATION

Teachers College, Columbia University

September 2021–May 2026

PhD in Economics and Education

University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy

September 2013–May 2015

Master of Public Policy

American University

August 2010–August 2012

Master of Arts in Teaching

University of Scranton

September 2006–May 2010

Bachelor of Arts in English, Spanish, and Philosophy

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

Publications

- Susan Dynarski, CJ Libassi, Katherine Micheltore, and Stephanie Owen. “Closing the Gap: The Effect of Reducing Complexity and Uncertainty in College Pricing on the Choices of Low-Income Students” *American Economic Review*, 2021
- Zachary Mabel, CJ Libassi, and Michael Hurwitz. “The value of using early-career earnings data in the College Scorecard to guide college choices” *Economics of Education Review*, 2020

Working Papers

- Elizabeth Burland, Nora Delaney, Susan Dynarski, Katherine B. Leu, CJ Libassi, Katherine Micheltore, Stephanie Owen, Mary A. Quiroga, and Elizabeth Salinas. “Degrees of Mobility: Shifting Low-Income Students to Higher Quality Colleges”, *NBER Working Paper No. 35434*, July 2026
- Judith Scott-Clayton, Veronica Minaya, CJ Libassi, and Joshua K.R. Thomas. “Who Rides Out the Storm? The Immediate Post-College Transition and its Role in Socioeconomic Earnings Gaps”, *NBER Working Paper No. 34366*, October 2025

- CJ Libassi, Michel Grosz, Sophie McGuinness, Jordan Matsudaira, and Rajeev Darolia. “An Overview of Graduate Borrowing and Outcomes”, *OCE Working Paper No. OCE2024-007, US Department of Education, January 2025*

Works in Progress

- CJ Libassi. “Pell Away from the Cutoffs: A Simulated Instrument Approach to Estimating the Effects of the Pell Grant from Changes in Formula Generosity Over Time”

SELECTED OTHER WRITING

- CJ Libassi and Julia Turner. “Debt and Earnings in Graduate School: Moving Beyond Standard Measures for the Typical Student in the Short Term.” PSEO Coalition, 2025.
- CJ Libassi and Zachary Mabel. “A Closer Look at College Affordability: The Link between Living Allowances and Student Debt.” Urban Institute, 2022.
- Judith Scott-Clayton, CJ Libassi, and Daniel Sparks. “The Fine Print on Free College: Who Benefits from New York’s Excelsior Scholarship? An Essay for the Learning Curve.” Urban Institute, 2022.
- Jennifer Ma, Matea Pender, CJ Libassi, and Sandy Baum. “Trends in College Pricing and Trends in Student Aid.” College Board, 2018, 2019, 2020.
- CJ Libassi. “The Neglected College Race Gap: Racial Disparities Among College Completers.” Center for American Progress, 2018.
- Ben Miller and CJ Libassi. “Sharing the Risk: A Plan for Colleges to Participate in the Costs of Student Loan Failure.” Center for American Progress, 2016.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

George Washington University	Washington, DC
<i>Professorial Lecturer, Data Analysis for Journalism and Political Communication</i>	Spring 2018–2021

FELLOWSHIPS

Institute of Education Sciences Predoctoral Training Grant, PEAR Fellowship	2021–2025
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GRANTS RECEIVED

2025: PSEO Coalition Research Grant: “Debt and Earnings in Graduate School: Moving Beyond Standard Measures for the Typical Student in the Short Term” (Co-Principal Investigator with Julia Turner), \$15,000

INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

2025: APPAM Fall Research Conference (Seattle, WA), MidSouth Education Policy Workshop; **2024:** Office of the Chief Economist Conference, US Department of Education (Washington, DC); **2021:** Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP); **2020:** Society of Government Economists (SGE); **2019:** APPAM Fall Research Conference; **2018:** Southern Economic Association (SEA)

SERVICE

Referee: *Economics of Education Review*, *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Social Science Review*

Co-organizer: DC Economics of Education Seminar Series (2017–2019)